to persons in advanced life are so dangerous and difficult to repair.

Without entering into the minutiæ of detail which belongs to the anatomy of the bones, it is enough to call attention to the beautiful mechanism of which the frame-work is composed, the position it occupies in the human economy, and to note how admirably the finest principles of mechanics are carried out in the articulation of the several joints, and the freedom with which every part of the structure moves.

The respiratory apparatus commences with the mouth, which conducts the inhaled air through the trachea (windpipe) into the lungs. The trachea is a strong, highly elastic tube, composed of muscular, fibrous, and mucous membranes, all of which line and connect about eighteen cartilaginous rings, the contractile action of which is admirably adapted to produce the various inflexions of the voice essential in speaking or singing.

We may here pause to remark that all portions of the viscera or internal organs that are exposed to the air are lined with mucous membrane, and all the internal organs themselves are inclosed in sacs of serous membrane, the office of which is to secrete a watery fluid, called serum. It is by the effusion of serum that the various organs are lubricated, and any undue irritation, from their friction one upon the other, is avoided.

The trachea terminates, as it enters the thorax, in two arches, called bronchi, and these, dividing off into the right and the left lung, subdivide and ramify into an immense system of tubing, every fibre of which